

No. 748, March 2012

Vertigo

Newsletter of the New Zealand Alpine Club
Wellington Section

www.nzalpine.wellington.net.nz www.facebook.com/nzacwellington

Lorrain Johns on Nun's Veil in
Mount Cook National Park
Image courtesy of Simon Bell

Next section night: 5 March, 2012

Short Talks Night – Places You'll Want to Go Too!

If you're keen to come along for the first time, and would like to be met at the door, please contact Lorraine Johns at lj@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz

Mt Tutoko – Simon Bell

Tutoko (2723m) is the highest peak in Fiordland National Park. The South East Ridge is widely considered to be one of New Zealand's finest alpine routes. Come hear about our experiences on this fantastic trip, including:

- forgetting our crampons and almost aborting the climb before we even flew in
- climbing three rock sections on excellent rock (up to grade 14)
- eating OSMs for breakfast, crackers for lunch and Backcountry for dinner
- climbing steep snow and ice with two tools and magnificent views
- spending two nights at an awesome rock bivvy
- 18 abseils off slings and v-threads (and only got the rope stuck once!)
- walking out to Milford in search of a bed only to end up bivvying at a camp site.



Simon Bell with Mt Tutoko and the rock steps, behind (Vaughan Snowdon)

NZAC High Alpine Course Skills – Dan Pringle

This New Year, Bec Thomson, Lindsay Turner and Dan Pringle from the Wellington Section joined five other students and two guides in a fantastic NZAC organised High Alpine Skills Course. Dan will share the highlights, key lessons and show some pretty pictures from the trip out from Barron Saddle. Learn more about these great courses and do one next year!

Field trip to Antarctica – Chris Gregory

The Postgraduate Certificate in Antarctic Studies (PCAS) is a 14-week course on the history, science, politics, environmental issues and future challenges for Antarctica and the Southern Ocean. This course has been developed jointly by the University of Canterbury and Antarctica New Zealand, with significant input from individuals, government agencies and a wider international Antarctic community. The course includes a field trip to Antarctica. Chris will provide a brief overview of the course and speak on his time in Antarctica over the Christmas holidays.

North Buttress of Mt Sabre – Derek Cheng

In the magnificent vista from Adelaide Saddle, there is one epic mountain that stands out from the other steep, rocky peaks that tower menacingly over the waters of Lake Adelaide. Mt Sabre, at 2162m, is one of the country's classic peaks, and considered the finest rock ascent in the Darran Mountains. The direct route up the prominent north buttress is an adventure fraught with risk ... but the rewards are infinite.

Mt Pollux – Nina Sawicki

Piers Harris, Mark Henson and Nina Sawicki attempted a climb of Mt Pollux on New Years Eve 2011. Although we did not summit, we had an interesting day on a series of bluffs and were "mazed out" by crevasses slowing progress and thwarting the elusive summit. We had spectacular weather, but poor snow conditions, and had an unexpected night out bivvying on steep tussock in a gully. Sadly, we arrived back at Top Forks Hut to be part of a search and body recovery of one of our other party members on Mt Twilight.

Club nights are at Turnbull House, on the first unimpeded Monday of every month. New and prospective members are welcome. Meetings and talks start at 8.00 pm with club business and tea & coffee afterwards. Meet for dinner at the Backbencher public bar at 6.30 pm and on to Turnbull House at 7.30 pm for a catch up.

AIC 2012 – instructors wanted!

We've started to organise AIC 2012, and it's going to be a good one! If you think you'd like to instruct this year, please contact the Chief Instructor, Fraser Crichton (aic@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz).

All applications are welcome – we want both assistant instructors and full instructors. Instructor training and development are an important part of our preparation, and instructors are now required to have undertaken an outdoor first aid course and a basic avalanche course in order to instruct. We will fully fund our instructors to undertake these courses.

We are seeking expressions of interest early this year to make sure there is sufficient time for instructors to complete their training. Several of our instructors completed an outdoor first aid course run by MSC in December, and another course will be run in late February, so the earlier you get in touch with us, the better.

The AIC is likely to take place from late July through to the beginning of September. Contact Fraser for further information about potential dates.



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A Mischievous Fairie Queene (and her ravenous sandflies and spiders) – Waitangi Weekend 2012

Lorrain Johns

To celebrate Waitangi Day this year, Nina Sawicki, Simon Bell and Lorraine Johns decided to launch a covert mission to conquer the crowning glory of the Spencer Mountains, “the Faerie Queene” (named after Britain’s Queen Elizabeth I, or more precisely, named after a 16th century poem by Edmund Spencer, written in her honour).

On the way to the road end, plotting over pies and hot chocolate at the Culverden Bakery, I warned my fellow adventurers that, in the mystical realm of the Faerie Queene, there would be no cute elves, singing pixies and laughing unicorns. Little did we know, however, that we would encounter an evil host of treacherous vampires (also known as sandflies) and terrifying creatures with sharp pincers (also known as spiders), which guard the Queene’s flanks in summer. Inconspicuous, with helmets, ice axes and crampons dangling from our packs, we slunk down the St James Walkway to Camera Gully Gorge. Once there, like in a game of chess, we would commence a series of strategic manoeuvres to take out the Queene.

For those who cross Waiau Pass or wander the Saint James, the Fairie Queene dominates the landscape in Lewis Pass, sprawling the length of the valley as it opens up nearing the Waiau River. However, once we were opposite the entrance to Camera Gully Gorge, all we could see were some rather hostile looking bluffs. A closer examination of the map confirmed that the best option for a high camp was right where we were standing, despite difficulty in finding a single spot which was not host to a spider’s nest. As the area was swarming with the Queene’s spies, we retreated early to the “safety” of our tent, trying not to think too hard about everything else that had retreated with us.

We were up and off in the dark, still being chased by creatures set on extracting our blood from our bodies. The first challenge of the climb was to gain safe ground above an eight-metre waterfall. Here, the top secret mission planning document we were using (also known as

a guidebook), suggests that you bypass the waterfall on the true left of the river. Of course, going up on the true left would have been what the Queene was expecting. Cunningly, we went up on the true right. After a sidle on some grade 14 grass (aye, there is such a thing), Nina and I declared we would rather climb up the waterfall than retrace our steps, so it was on the true right we continued, emerging well above the river and the route.

The next challenge was to interpret the guidebook’s directions, which commanded us to strike out above a tarn and gain a ridge south of Gloriana. There was a slight hitch in that the ridge south of Gloriana leads you to ... well ... Gloriana. Not Fairie Queene. The only tarn in existence also led to Gloriana. We could have been confused, but we knew this was all part of the Fairie Queene’s mischievous plan to mislead us. Following our noses, we continued north, as the river disappeared under our feet below a towering mound of scree.

At this point, the Queene woke to the realisation that her outermost defences had been breached. Suddenly, cloud began to roll in. At the same that Nina and Simon speculated, “This doesn’t look ominous”, I exclaimed, “This looks ominous!” We then lost visibility for the climb, at the same time as discovering that the Queene suffers from serious choss outbreaks in summer. We followed Simon through the crux of the climb, which turned out to be the 200m just below the summit ridge. The rock wasn’t too bad, but it wasn’t too great either, and visibility was down to 20m, which did not help with assessing the best line. We were wondering if the Queene was going to turn out to be a bit shabby, in her summer garb.

Once on the ridge, it was checkmate for the Queene. Despite a deep, narrow, rock crevasse (the words “nasty rash” came to mind), and a tiny, almost cheval-like section, the rocky kilometre-long ridge was a straightforward pleasure to traverse. However, the Fairie Queene did have one final trick up her royal robe. Upon reach-

ing a pole we thought marked the summit, and dropping our packs, Simon pointed out that he could see another pole on a rocky outcrop that looked slightly higher. Dutifully, we continued on. A little to our surprise, despite the grade of Fairie Queene, there was something bordering on a grade 10 rock step leading to the true summit. We noticed someone had left gear for an abseil.

On the summit, some little sort of geodactic trig, complete with graffiti, persisted. It looked like the Queene had lost her temper with its predecessor, which was smeared over various rocks. Despite the limited visibility we got at the trig, the weather had cleared enough at times on the ridge, to let us glimpse a passing view in most directions. It was a stunning place. The gnarly ridge leading along the Spencer Mountains is striking. The wide Saint James valley is picturesque. But most of all, I appreciated the view into the Matakītaki, with shining little tarns; the gleam of a larger lake; large tussock benches with sweeping rock slabs above; and mountains looming through cloud everywhere, black and white and jagged. I think Fairie Queene would be a dream to ascend from this side, with a high camp based near one of the many tarns.

Soon, however, it was time to head down. This was largely due to the plague of sandflies that had congregated on our sweaty packs at over 2000m, while we were detouring to the real summit. As everything else was tucked away under clothes and gear, they had reached a new low of feasting on our faces.

Perhaps, sufficiently appeased by the delight we displayed on summiting, the Fairie Queene permitted us an uneventful and quick descent, despite some rain. The scree crux hadn't really improved since we last saw it, and we were grateful to Simon who picked a safe route down. We had ditched the ice axes and crampons the previous day, but it turned out that there were still a few very deep, compact basins, that were impassable for our group without gear. Thus did we ultimately end up grovelling between a rock and a hard place (a shrund, hugged by steep, loose choss), using some pointy rocks as ice axes to downclimb the last ten metres of snow to easy ground. This time we took the true left of the waterfall, a route plagued by speargrass.

Nina then, queen-like, commanded a sleep in, after we consumed her delicious dinner. We eventually woke the next morning to discover little red welts all over our legs. The Queene's vicious little vampire army had bitten us a multitude of times through trousers and whatever else we were wearing (the head to toe insect repellent I had been wearing seemed to do little more than season me to taste). Perhaps the Fairie Queene had also detected my irreverence for her beloved Spencer, as I managed to get bitten by a spider that crawled down my gaiter during the walk out – turns out that I am allergic to spiders. However, the feeling of being under siege (and in pain) soon passed, as we were already daydreaming about visiting a snowy Gloriana and conceiving other grand adventures in the spectacular Spencer Mountains.



Mount Arrowsmith – November 2011

Kevin Patterson

Arrowsmith has long been on my tick list for a while, it is one of the 15 "Classic Peaks". However it has a reputation for rebuffing many honest attempts. For anytime of the year apart from a three to four week window around October to November, there is either too much snow so too avalanchy, or too little snow so danger of rockfall and crevasse travel becomes difficult. Which is tricky as well as this time of the year the weather is fairly unstable. So one day in early November I met up with Paul "Action" Mason for an attempt on its eastern face. "Action" had just come from a weekend multisport event, his car is chocka with three kayaks, two mountainbikes and lots of stuff – very cool.

We went in from the Mt Arrowsmith road end (near Lake Heron Station) and up the Cameron River. What a cracker day for a walk in, turned out to be one of the last of the good ones, though it did rain heavily the night before. Heading up the Cameron in the afternoon, the track is discontinuous in places but it would have been reasonably easy going apart from the 22 kg pack! Took me 6.5 hours to get to the hut – too late to go further.

We headed up the middle of the Cameron glacier the next day in deteriorating weather. The "Carriageway" up and on top of the moraine

on the true right used to be the standard access route, but the glacier has dropped way too far for this to work now. At 1700 m we took a left turn (right goes to Jagged col), and then headed further left up a wide couloir next to a rock buttress at 1900 m. It was rather confusing to pick the right line but Paul had been here before.

After the buttress at 2000 m we headed on a rising traverse left under an icefall. After 4 hours from the hut we reached an open area (2170m). Here on the South Cameron Glacier we pitched our tent and built a snow wall around it in winds that gradually rose to 70 kph. Viz dropped to 50 m. Next day the wind had stopped however it continued to snow lightly all day.

Unbelievably the temperature inside the tent rose from 2C to 25C by 11am, and then topped out at 36C by 2pm! There was enough UV filtering through, which after it converted to IR on hitting the snow, just couldn't escape through the mist. Turning the place into a microwave oven. It only stopped snowing at 8pm but visibility was still bad at 10.30pm so we didn't hold out much hope. We set the alarm at 2am for a look-see.

It's 2am and it's all clear – yay! Plus there's been a slight freeze. Only about three to four inches of snow has fallen too. 3.10am and





we're off! We needed to rope up soon after leaving the tent, as we are in crevassed terrain. Paul heads off at a cracker pace, and by 5am we've climbed to 2500 m and are at the base of two snow couloirs – one leads directly to the summit, the other to the right. We select the right hand couloir which ascends slightly less steeply with no mixed terrain. The direct one appeared to have a rock step about 50 m up from its base.

The sun comes up at 6am, we are near the top of the couloir, and the temperature starts to rocket away – we are facing directly towards it. From the summit ridge, the summit is 200 m away. We try to pitch the rocks but quickly abandon this idea – too loose and icy. We traverse onto the steep shaded (right) side and do two traversing pitches over icy snow, before reacquiring the ridge for the last 100 m of easy travel to the summit. We arrive at 8am in little wind, fabulous views and a blue sky day. As we look down we see early morning mist filling the valleys to the east. In the distance are Cook and Tasman.

After a short break we start to rap down the main couloir which is rapidly softening using two

50 m ropes, rapping off protruding rocks from the summit ridge and from the rock buttress on the right (five raps). At 10am we are back at the base of the couloirs which are now very soft and at risk of avalanching. It is way too difficult/dangerous to climb these couloirs now and explains why so few (less than 10%) are successful on Arrowsmith. You must arrive at their base no later than an hour before sunrise, which means starting from the hut you would probably need to go from 10pm? It is a very straight forward grade 1-2 climb if your timing is good.

There are about six possible routes from the South Cameron Glacier, however all involve crossing the glacier and ascending steep snow couloirs. As all these possibilities are east facing they go rapidly out of condition in the morning sun.

We were back at the tent by 11.30am, then down to the hut by 2pm. "Action" leads the way (wants to go kayaking the next day) and so in one non-stop push we are out to the roadend by 8pm in deteriorating weather. On the walk out it starts to rain heavily, we made our climb but only just in the narrowest of weather windows.

Tackle the North Wall

The alpine weather has got the better of the north wall of our hut at Tukino.

So we're recladding it and we need as much help as possible. We'll consider anybody no matter what your skills are. We've got lots of jobs, ranging from painting, stuffing insulation, to fastening the cladding. It should be a fun weekend, and if we have enough people, you might be able to sneak off for a little while to scout out some of the rock climbing potential.

When: 23rd to 25th March (reserve weekend April 20-22)

Interested? Then contact Don French on 027 445 2980 or email don.f@xtra.co.nz



Wellington Section Webmaster Vacancy (volunteer role)

The Wellington Section is looking for a new webmaster. The role entails keeping the Section's website up-to-date with information relevant to members, including Section night information, upcoming trip information, Vertigo, various newsworthy items and general maintenance of the site.

See www.nzalpine.wellington.net.nz for the Section's website.

The website uses the Wordpress Content Management System. It's easy to learn so if you're keen to get into the world of web development and content management then this is the opportunity for you.

As well as general updating this role may occasionally involve some liaison with NZAC head office's publications convenor regarding the Club's national website strategy.

The ideal person would be someone who enjoys climbing and is keen to help keep Section members informed of the goings on of the Section.

If this sounds like something you'd be interested in helping with please send an e-mail to secretary@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz

Do you own or use a Personal Locator Beacon?

On a recent trip one of the Section's Personal Locator Beacons (PLB) got activated in an emergency. The ensuing rescue operation brought to light several issues concerning the effectiveness of a PLB:

- Trigger the PLB in an area with satellite coverage (if possible). Our beacon was activated in a narrow gorge, so the beacon could not be located via its GPS by the rescue coordination. If you have the choice, bring the PLB into an open area before setting it off.
- If you own a beacon, register it with the rescue coordination centre and provide a good emergency contact.
- Leave detailed trip intentions and contact info for each participant with the emergency contact. For the Section, this is done by sending an email to an account that will be accessed by S&R in an emergency.
- For Section PLBs, read and follow the instructions carefully when signing it out.
- A PLB that has been activated must be sent back to the manufacturer. However, it will not be sent back but replaced with a new unit that has a different UIN number. You must register this new unit with S&R (for Section PLBs this is all done by the PLB warden).

We are revising our procedures for signing out the Section's PLBs to ensure maximum safety for trips. If you have any questions contact Hinrich at trips@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz

Call for trips

There are currently no upcoming trips because we are moving to a new way of organizing outings, and we have not have anyone volunteer to lead a trip so far. Please give the following some thought.

Shared outings are the true purpose of our club. They allow us all to discover new destinations, make new friendships and learn from other's skills. We are fortunate to have many members capable of organizing and leading trips – but in the last year we had only three (!) members step forward and volunteer to conduct a trip.

All other trips were conceived by the trip coordinator who then looked for someone to lead it, generally among those who signed up as participants. In several cases, this meant that trips did not go ahead. In general, this places strong limitations on the variety of trips. More importantly, it means that people may be pressured into leading a trip they are not comfortable with.

With this in mind we are moving to a trip schedule where each outing is suggested, organised and conducted by a competent leader. Please consider volunteering to lead a trip for the upcoming autumn and winter schedule. Trips of any activity (rock climbing, mountaineering, tramping, mountain biking, trail running etc.), any duration and any level are welcome. The trip coordinator and senior members are happy to help with ideas, questions, and planning – you will not be left alone.

If we don't get any volunteers to lead trips we cannot conduct outings. If, however, we get members like yourself to lead just one trip a year we will have a vibrant and interesting trip schedule and section.

Please contact me with a suggestion for a trip, or any questions regarding the schedule, by March 15th.

Sincerely,

Hinrich Schaefer

Trip coordinator for the NZAC Wellington Section

Tel.: 021 2986894

trips@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz

Notices

Special offers

Wellington and Whanganui Rock

Get these two guidebooks for only \$20 while stocks last from <https://alpineclub.org.nz/product/wellington-rock-whanganui-rock-combo-special>

10mm ring hangers

Currently \$10 each for members, but only 21 left in stock. Price will increase to \$13 when

these run out, so be in now to get the cheaper rate. <https://alpineclub.org.nz/product/hanger-10mm-with-ring>

NZAC 2012 Alpine Calendar

Only a dozen still remaining at the special \$10 price. <https://alpineclub.org.nz/product/nzac-alpine-calendar-2012-special>

Remarkables Mixed Ice and Mixed Festival

The inaugural Remarkables Ice and Mixed Festival will be held at Queenstown August 16-19. Bringing together the top winter alpine climbers in NZ as a means of advancing and promoting modern mixed climbing. Places are filling

up fast and are limited so people will need to register early if they want a spot. See here for more details and links: <https://alpineclub.org.nz/event/2012/08/16/remarkables-ice-mixed-festival>

FMC newsletter

The February newsletter is now available on the FMC website at:

<http://www.fmc.org.nz/wp-content/uploads/Newsletter/Club1202.pdf>

Unwin news

Dean Buchanan has arrived at Unwin Lodge to commence a month as "artist in residence". He has set up an outside studio against the back wall of the old bunkrooms and has commenced painting a large work which depicts Aoraki/Mt Cook and the Tasman valley looking down from the summit of Nuns Veil. It is fascinating and a privilege to watch his work develop from a blank canvas and to slowly see the landscape come alive.

Dean will be here for a month and during that time he will be involved in a TVNZ documentary and doing some climbing. He loves chatting about his work and about climbing, so come on down to Unwin and see it all happening. For pictures of this and other things going on at Unwin and the Aoraki/Mt Cook region, see the Blog site at: <http://alpineclub.org.nz/hut/unwin/blog>

The Climber Magazine 80th Issue Creative Writing Competition

This is open to all readers of the magazine. The topic should be about the mountains or a climbing/snow/ice related sport. 1500 word maximum. Deadline April 30th. Send your

creations to Pat at: pat@alpineclub.org.nz as a MS Word, RTF or text file attachment, or post to PO BOX 786, Christchurch.

Mountain Photography Course – second course now scheduled

Due to popular demand a second four-day mountain photography course with renowned landscape photographer Colin Monteath is now scheduled for 22–25 June at the new improved Unwin Lodge, Aoraki Mt Cook.

Christchurch-based Colin Monteath is a world renowned polar and mountain photographer who has had 30 seasons in Antarctica and four in the Arctic. He has climbed and trekked throughout the Southern Alps since 1967 and around the world since 1974, including 21 expeditions to Himalayan countries. He has written 10 books and supplied images to many others. In 1984, after his return from the North Face of Everest, Colin set up a photo library www.hedgehoghouse.com. See also: www.colinmonteath.com

This course is aimed at keen “intermediate” digital or film photographers who want to extend their skills to produce better mountain landscape images. Course participants will have all their own camera equipment and, if shooting digitally, an ability to download files into their own portable computer.

There will be evening lectures on adventures and expedition photojournalism as well as sessions to discuss techniques and raw file pro-

cessing. The course aims to spend one night in Mueller Hut to take images of the sunset and dawn.

After the course, processed images will be discussed and a selection sent to The Climber and/or New Zealand Alpine Journal for publication. Images may also be submitted to NZAC’s photo competition later in the year.

Participants are expected to arrive by 6pm April 12th for a welcome dinner with the ‘painters.’ Departure will be mid-afternoon on April 16th.

Course cost: \$750 per person, which includes all instruction, accommodation and transport Chch-Mt Cook-Chch if required and evening meals on the nights of the 12th/13th/14th and 15th.

You will be required to pay a \$300 non refundable deposit to secure your place on the course. Cancellation insurance is available. Applicants must be members of the NZAC (Full info available on the NZAC website: <https://alpineclub.org.nz/news/2012/an-opportunity-not-to-be-missed-four-day-mountain-photography-workshop-with-colin-monteath>).

NZAC now on Twitter and Facebook

You can now follow the New Zealand Alpine Club’s activities on Twitter @nzalpineclub and Facebook www.facebook.com/groups/5638346254/

You can follow the Wellington Section at www.facebook.com/nzacwellington

Stay at Tukino this summer

Stay at Tukino this summer at \$15 per night for NZAC members.

bookings@TukinoAlpineSportsClub.org.nz



Queenstown Rock, Ice and Mixed

Upcoming second edition of Queenstown Rock, Ice and Mixed: information needed!

Information about new routes, crags and areas is now being collated for the next edition of the Queenstown Rock, Ice and Mixed. This guidebook will have a very different look to its predecessor with lots of extras. It will also comprehensively cover the iconic Mt Earnslaw and nearby peaks. If you wish to contribute and

have any info about routes (new or existing) that you have climbed around Queenstown, or if you have climbed routes on Mt Earnslaw or other peaks in the Rees, Dart or Routeburn valleys, please email us at queenstownclimbing@gmail.com.

Cheers,

Guillaume

New Member Discount - A Plus Lodge & Iwiheke Backpacker

Run by Richard Seddon's son Ian, discounted accommodation is available to FMC, NZAC, and Alpine Sports Club members. Accommodation is available for \$16 per night per person, or a family of four will pay just \$50 per room.

They have double rooms, single, share or dormitory style beds. Check out www.tongariro-hostel.co.nz

Four day painting workshop – one space left

There is one space left on the four day painting workshop with renowned Christchurch artist Jane Zusters, April 13th–16th at the new improved Unwin Lodge, Aoraki Mt Cook.

This four day workshop is for both beginners and experienced painters and the focus will be on the development of each individual's painting practice through a guided encounter with the Mt Cook environment. Jane's focus is on enabling each individual's creative journey rather than adhering to any particular technique, style or genre. Through creative exercises and a focus on the physical environment, students will be encouraged to use the workshop as a launching pad to fuel their own art exploration.

Medium: Acrylics

Arrival time: Meet at Unwin Lodge at 6.00 pm April 12th for a prepared dinner at 6.30 pm.

Departure time: Around 3 pm on April 16th.

Numbers: Max 6

Cost: \$700.00

Applicants must be NZAC members. The course fee includes instruction, accommodation and

evening meals. It doesn't include transport. You will be expected to pay a \$300 deposit at the time of registration to secure your place on the course. Cancellation insurance is available.

Christchurch based Jane Zusters is an experienced art tutor who has facilitated numerous painting workshops, including classes at Artstation, Auckland University Extension Studies and Whanganui Polytechnic. Her philosophy is to make art from the life experiences that she feels passionate about. She has exhibited widely throughout New Zealand since the 70s and is in most major national public collections including Te Papa Tongarewa, the Christchurch Art Gallery and Southland Museum and Art Gallery. See www.janezusters.co.nz for further information on Jane's artwork.

The course cost includes all instruction, accommodation and evening meals on the nights of the 12th/13th/14th and 15th.

If you are interested in this course, please contact Pat Deavoll at pat@alpineclub.org.nz for a registration form and an equipment list.

Notices

National Speaker Tour: Canadian ice climber Barry Blanchard

Barry Blanchard is known worldwide as the father of modern Canadian waterfall ice climbing and technical high risk routes in the Canadian Rockies and Greater Ranges. He will be coming to New Zealand in late September to do a

Speaker Tour for the NZAC. He will be presenting in Auckland, Wellington, Nelson, Christchurch, Dunedin and Wanaka.

More details to come shortly....

Arthurs Pass Guide Update

Have you done a new route at Arthurs Pass that is not at the current guide book (published

2004). The fame could be yours! Send your new routes to : kester@alpineclub.org.nz

Remarkables Ice & Mixed Festival August 16th–19th 2012

The inaugural Remarkables Ice & Mixed Festival will be held at Queenstown on 16th–19th August.

This event will bring together the top winter alpine climbers in New Zealand as a means of advancing and promoting modern mixed climbing, and will showcase the new and existing route potential on New Zealand's most accessible multipitch winter training area. Sharing local knowledge and forming new climbing

partnerships will be a key aim, and all festival attendees will receive the latest guide for the Remarkables. This will have over 30 unclimbed routes and detailed information on more than 150 possible summer and winter climbs.

For further details and info on how to register, visit <http://www.iceandmixedfestival.co.nz/>

<http://www.facebook.com/#!/pages/Remarkables-Ice-Mixed-Festival/130651843714800>

Mt Arrowsmith Images Request

Requesting images taken from Mt. Arrowsmith looking toward Jagged Peak with Cameron Glacier in the photo. I realise this is quite specific, but if people have such a photo, could they send me their name, the date they took the photo, and permission to use the image in scientific talks about snow avalanches, glacier

mass balance, and modelling this process. I am a PhD student at Victoria University studying some South Island glaciers. The photographer's name will be shown on the photo and in the acknowledgements in presentations. Thank you for your time. Alice Doughty (NZAC member) alice.doughty@gmail.com

New General Manager

NZAC is pleased to announce the appointment of Sam Newton as the new NZAC General Manager. Sam is currently working as a Parliamentary Advisor in Wellington, and will relocate to Christchurch to begin work with NZAC from 10 April. For a full copy of the NZAC me-

dia release see this link: <https://alpineclub.org.nz/news/2012/new-nzac-general-manager-appointed>

We'll have more details on Sam in the upcoming Climber magazine, due out by the end of March.

Huts Update

De la Beche hut was demolished and removed from its site in Aoraki Mt Cook National Park last week. The base frame has been left in place, giving the Club the opportunity to replace this hut in the future. See this link for photos: <https://alpineclub.org.nz/hut/de-la-beche>

Whangaehu hut is now open again, after a huge effort from Club volunteers in our Central North Island section. A special thank you to both Richard Knott and Dennis Sanders for their hard work. See this link for photos of the shiny new Whangaehu: <https://alpineclub.org.nz/hut/whangaehu>

Wellington Section 2011/12 contacts list

Position	Name	Email alias*	Phone
Chairperson	vacant	chairperson	
Vice Chair	Hinrich Schaefer	vicechair	
Secretary	Catherine Moger	secretary or CM2	04 973 1307 (h), or 021 079 0854
Treasurer	Matt Knarston	treasurer	
National Rep	vacant		
Patron	John Nankervis		
Trips	Hinrich Schaefer	Trips	
Other Committee Members	Steve Minchin	SM	
	Vincent Zintzen	VZ	
	Nina Sawicki	NS	
	Dan Pringle	DP	
	Lorraine Johns	LJ	
Other Roles:			
Gear	vacant	gear	
Personal Locator Beacons	Hinrich Schaefer	PLB	
Instruction Coordinator	vacant		
Instruction - AIC	Fraser Crichton		
Instruction - Rock	Blair Hiscoke	summerrock or BH	
Library	Joke Meerkens	library	
Newsletter Editor	Steve Minchin	newsletter or SM	
Rock Drill Overseer	Kristen Foley	drill or KF	
Website	vacant	webmaster	
* Email address is: alias@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz eg. secretary@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz			
Any membership, Distaghil Sar Fund, or general queries should be directed to the secretary			
Any media queries should be directed to:			
03 377 595	National Executive Officer	Ollie Clifton	ollie@alpineclub.org.nz



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